

NEW PATIENT MARKETING PLAN

A Scratch-Practice Launch Strategy, Raleigh, NC

The Situation

Scratch Practice

New dentist opening in Raleigh, NC. No existing patients, no online history, no reviews to lean on.

6-Month Runway

Client is coming to Wonderist 6 months before opening, the top of Wonderist's recommended 4-6 month window.

The Goal

A booked schedule on day one.

Target Patient & Positioning

514K

Raleigh population, up 10% since 2020

3 in 4

new residents are transplants without a local dentist yet

7.9 / 10K

dentists per capita in Wake County, above the national average

92%

of residents carry insurance

Who we're reaching

- Newcomers first: migration drives 3 of every 4 new Raleigh residents, and most arrive with no local dentist.
- High-intent searchers: “dentist near me,” “new patient dentist Raleigh,” “emergency dentist Raleigh”
- Local social audiences who respond to authentic, non-corporate content, not stock photography

How we position the practice

- Wake County has more dentists per capita than the national average, so differentiation matters here than in an underserved market
- A brand-new, modern practice built around the doctor's own story, not a generic “new office” message
- Fast, easy, and welcoming: emphasize same-week appointments and a frictionless new-patient process

The 6-Month Build

Timing	Phase	What Happens
Months 6-5	Foundation	Website, Google Business Profile, CRM/lead tracking, local SEO, and authentic social presence begin.
Months 4-3	Pre-Launch Visibility	Google Ads and social ads go live. New-patient waitlist opens and feeds the CRM.
Months 2-1	Push to Opening	Spend ramps up, limited-time new-patient offer converts the waitlist into booked appointments.
Opening + 90 Days	Refine & Grow	Google Ads stays the primary channel. Budget shifts to what's converting, reviews pour in.

Channel Mix

Local SEO

LONG-TERM VISIBILITY

Location-specific website content, Google Business Profile, and backlinks build lasting organic rank for high-intent local searches.

Google Ads (PPC)

IMMEDIATE PATIENTS

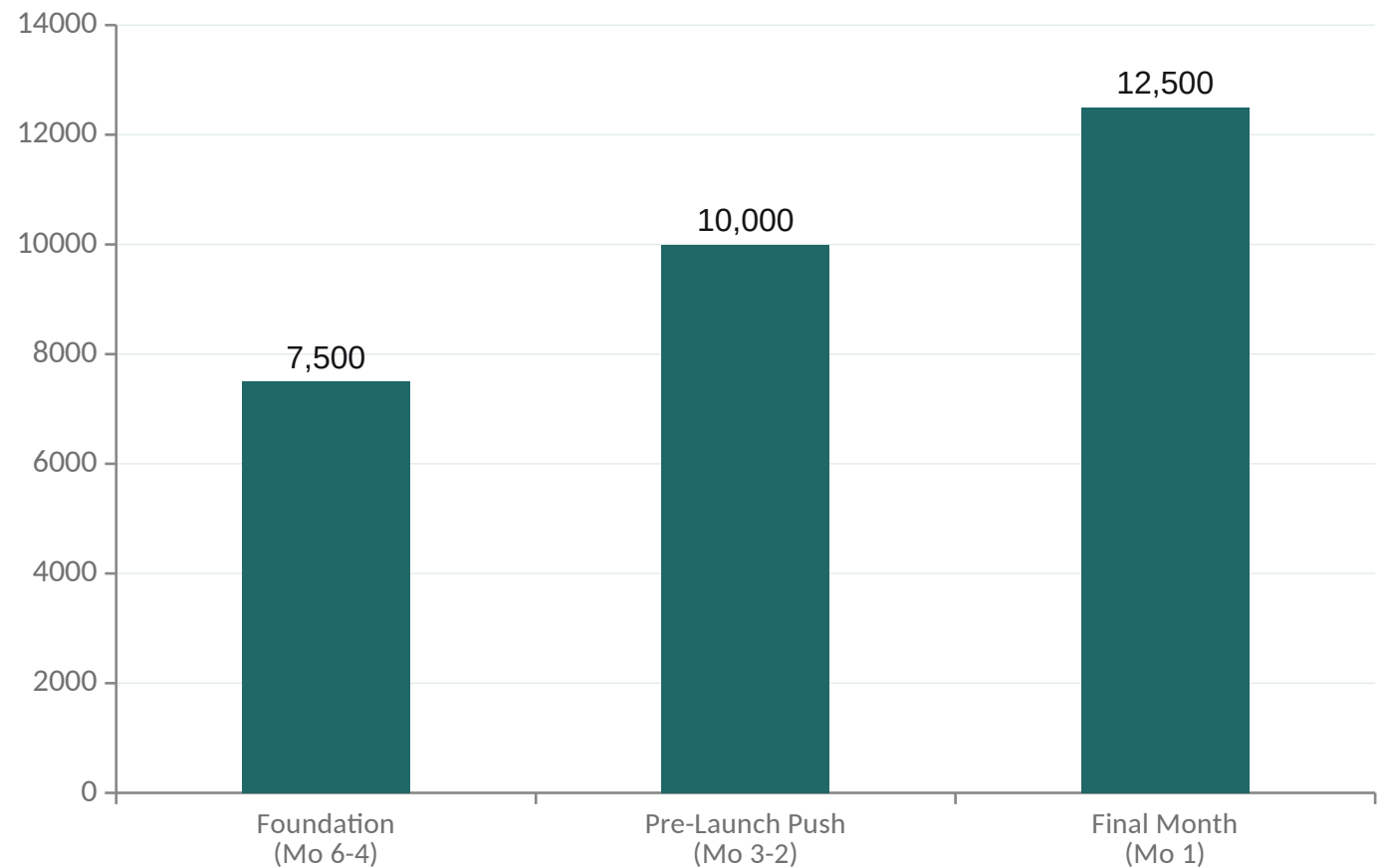
Primary new-patient acquisition channel. Targets high-intent keywords with a dedicated landing page for new patients.

Social Ads

AWARENESS & TRUST

Builds the feeling of competency before opening by using authentic content rather than stock imagery.

Budget Ramp



The Math

- New practices (0-2 years) run 15-25% of revenue on marketing
- $\$50,000 \times 15\% = \$7,500/\text{mo}$ while the foundation (site, GBP, CRM) is being built
- $\$50,000 \times 20\% = \$10,000/\text{mo}$ once ads go live and the waitlist starts filling
- $\$50,000 \times 25\% = \$12,500/\text{mo}$ in the final month, the top of the sourced range for a new practice

Success Metrics

Measured against patients acquired, not vanity metrics

Cost / Patient

What it costs to acquire one new patient, by channel

Booked by Day 1

New-patient appointments already on the schedule before opening

Top-of-Page Rate

Google Ads visibility on high-intent local keywords

Review Velocity

New Google reviews collected per month post-opening. (Encourage Google reviews)

**Let's fill the schedule
before day one.**

Sources

1	Wonderist's own 4-6 month startup timeline guidance <i>Wonderist Agency, "How Wonderist Can Help Market and Bring New Patients to Your Brand New Dental Practice," wonderistagency.com/blog/marketing-services-for-brand-new-dental-practices</i>
2	Wonderist scratch-practice client testimonials <i>Wonderist Agency, "Testimonials," wonderistagency.com/success-stories/testimonials</i>
3	Raleigh population and growth rate <i>World Population Review, "Raleigh, North Carolina Population 2026," worldpopulationreview.com/us-cities/north-carolina/raleigh</i>
4	Raleigh metro among fastest-growing in the U.S. <i>Axios Raleigh, "Raleigh's growth still among fastest in the nation," March 2026</i>
5	Wake County dentists per capita <i>NC Health Workforce, "NC's Dentist Workforce Continues to Grow, But Mostly in 5 Counties," nhealthworkforce.unc.edu</i>
6	Raleigh median household income and insurance coverage <i>City of Raleigh, City Profile, raleighnc.gov/planning/services/city-profile; U.S. Census Bureau QuickFacts</i>
7	Marketing budget as % of revenue, by practice age (new practice: 15-25%) <i>Dentplicity, "Budget Allocation Framework," dentplicity.com/blog/dental-marketing-plan-template-2026#budget-allocation-framework</i>